

Call of Duty WWII

The next Call of Duty is officially heading back to World War II after disappointing feedback from Infinite Warfare. <http://dgit.in/CODwwII>



Cassini's final mission

NASA's Cassini mission will enter its final phase this month. Studying Saturn more closely than ever before burning out. <http://dgit.in/Cassini2>

Bazaar

ASUS GL553VD Gaming Laptop

Gaming on a good budget

Being members of the #PCMasterRace, we don't generally approve of gaming laptops and it certainly gets on our nerves when folks ask for a gaming laptop under ₹30K (such a thing doesn't exist). But if you want to game on a laptop and wish to have a good time while you're at it, then the GTX 1050 is the bare minimum you should be looking at. The ASUS GL553 has two variants out in the market at the moment, the GL553VD and GL553VE, we've had the pleasure of trying out both and we prefer the one with the 1050 Ti (the E variant).

Build

The GL553VD is not overly heavy and at the same time doesn't compromise on the hardware it packs in. The keypad has chiclet keys with ample amount of spacing between individual keys making it easy to use compared to the average laptop keyboard and there's a different texture to the touchpad as well. But who uses the touchpad for gaming? The keyboard supports 30-key rollover which is more than sufficient for any gamer. Even a StarCraft player with insane APM wouldn't feel bottlenecked on this system. Another neat thing about the keyboard is the fact that the arrow keys jut out a little. So it's easier to get your bearing without looking down. The spacebar, too, has a little protrusion towards the bottom.

The CPU and GPU use the same heatpipes which isn't something we like. However, they've kept the right edge of the laptop devoid of any vents which is a good thing as while gaming your hand isn't bearing the brunt of hot air blasting through them. We've seen certain high-end gaming laptops make this silly mistake of placing cooling vents on the right side. Ideally, we prefer exhaust vents on the rear and intake vents on the bottom. A good thing about the ports on the GL553 is their placement. They're placed on the sides alright, but more towards the user. The USB Type-C and headphone jack, especially, benefit the most since most cables are either no more than three feet in length so you don't have to slouch over the laptop which you'd otherwise have to do had the audio jack been towards the rear.

Features

As with most gaming laptops these days, the ROG GL553VD comes with software that allows you



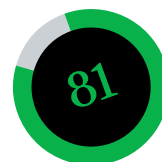
to tweak various aspects such as the fan speed profiles, keyboard illumination patterns and performance profiles. ASUS Gaming Center has a pretty easy to understand UI and we spent quite a bit of time playing around with the different patterns. Aside from that, we didn't find anything that stood out about the GL553.

The display panel on the GL553 is pretty good for a laptop. For starters, it scored 100% in the sRGB colour gamut but the maximum brightness level only hit up 273 lux which isn't particularly bad, however, it's lower than some of the competing units from MSI which generally score around 290.

Performance

Performance wise you'll be scoring above 30 FPS in most games while running at Very High settings. Just don't switch to a ridiculous level of anti-aliasing, FXAA and you should be just fine. Unigine Valley scored around 45 FPS average across the benchmark and FireStrike scored 5523. If we were to switch out the GTX 1050 for a 1050 Ti then the FireStrike score would jump to approximately 7900. In games, Doom scored about 42 FPS on max while Overwatch hit 54 FPS on ultra settings. So you'll have to tone things down a little to hit 60 FPS. Overall, the new GTX 10 series of graphics cards have really given gaming laptops a much needed shot in the arm. The GL553 competes with the likes of the MSI GP and GE series and they're competitive in terms of features. It's just the price that makes the competition seem all the more appealing.

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Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i7 7700HQ; **Platform:** HM175; **RAM:** 8 GB 2400 MHz; **Screen Size** - 15.6-inches; **Screen Resolution:** 1920x1080; **GPU:** 1050 4 GB; **SSD:** 128 GB; **HDD:** 1 TB 7200 RPM; **Battery:** 4-Cell 48 Whr; **AC Adapter:** 120 W; **Weight:** 2.5 Kg

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